



Established in Connecticut in 1958, BIC Consumer Products USA (BIC) is a leading distributor of stationery products, lighters, and shavers. BIC USA has honored the BIC brand's tradition of providing high-quality, affordable products that are accessible to all.

PARTNERSHIP OVERVIEW

Since 2011, BIC has expanded its Hanover Research partnership to serve additional product lines. Key users of the service include BIC's Lighter, Stationery, and Shaver brand management teams.

RESEARCH INITIATIVES

- Gain access to the consumer voice
- Delve into product preferences of target market segments
- Structure focus groups and consumer outreach efforts to devise actionable plans
- Guide business decisions with comprehensive research

"Partnering with Hanover helps BIC better understand our consumers. Our team works across departments to prioritize product launches and refinements, and then uses Hanover as a sounding board to determine the best way to extract consumer needs. We have internal marketers and researchers gathering secondary data, but Hanover helps us to understand on a deeper level how our target audience will respond to specific questions."

- Keith Last, Brand Manager-Lighters

RESEARCH GOALS

Keith Last and his brand management team look to Hanover to define consumer preferences and usage habits for lighter products. Additionally, BIC relies on Hanover to evaluate new product designs and niche consumer behavior.

With data-driven research, Keith and his team optimize BIC's marketing mix to attract and retain its target consumers.

HANOVER APPROACH

Hanover addresses BIC's objectives by testing different product concepts, and by conducting attitudes and usage surveys among distinct market segments. Through this research, Hanover has identified consumer purchasing criteria, brand loyalty drivers, consumer product preferences, and potential new audiences. Last elaborates:

"We act upon Hanover's data immediately to inform marketing decisions. Findings from Hanover reports often illuminate new insights we were unaware of previously, and these insights frequently boil up to the executive level in product presentations to then be integrated into BIC's larger business strategy."

BUSINESS IMPACT

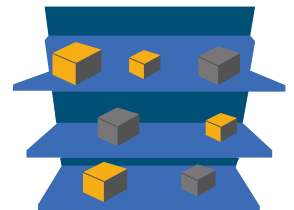
Hanover's research informs the strategies of BIC's sales team, which liaises with buyers to sell BIC's products into its over 3 million global retail outlets. Further, BIC uses Hanover's analyses to:



Resolve whether or not to introduce product lines to market or take certain marketing directions



Determine key purchase drivers for its product range



Make shelving decisions based on what packaging concepts are likely to increase sales

"We want buyers to learn what consumers want, and recognize that the product decisions we make are grounded in research. Because Hanover's research helps our retail teams build buyer interest, applying this data has resulted in an overall increase in lighter sales."

- Keith Last, Brand Manager-Lighters

BIC will continue to use Hanover's support to investigate consumer preferences and inform product decisions.

For more information regarding this case study, contact info@hanoverresearch.com